AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY · LIVE DEMO, LAUNCH CHECK PENDING · NOVEMBER 2026

AI Personal Stylist

A video stylist that jots notes as you talk, then builds looks you refine by voice or touch

For anyone dressing for an occasion on their phone. A working web app, built in three weeks by Sabine Joseph, an AI product manager directing Claude Code, with quality defined before it was measured.

97%
of notes within 2 seconds of their phrase (target 95%, in-sample)

96% / 83%
of note checks right, in-sample / blind set (target 90%; the blind set not met)

16 of 16
planted rule breaks caught by code before any look is shown

$1.15
of AI per 10-minute demo: 5 cents over the $1.10 target

The problem

Online shopping gives you a search box and a thousand results that don't go together. A good stylist listens, remembers, looks at what you own, and builds a whole outfit within your budget and rules. AI chat listens, then forgets your budget and shows you the heels you ruled out. The problem is my own: I shop for occasions on my phone.

What I built

- **My Styling Notes:** the stylist jots free-form notes while you talk; a tap confirms or removes one, a correction by voice rewrites it. Nothing is a rule until confirmed.
- **Looks around what you own:** a photo or the live camera names your item; three complete looks are built around it, your own pieces never in the totals.
- **One gate:** every look passes a preference check (rules in code, then a model's judgment) before it reaches the screen. Then keep, change, swap, undo, compare; save a look; a demo bag that cannot check out.
- **Degrade, never break; privacy and budget built in:** voice carries on when video can't; no recordings, photos deleted with the session, download or delete all; a daily allowance and monthly stops before every paid call.

Key decisions

- **A notebook, not a form:** notes in the stylist's own words, so the conversation feels heard; the price was a reader that must be fast and right mid-sentence.
- **The stylist only speaks and listens:** video and voice are swappable outside services; my server makes every decision and holds every key.
- **Accuracy first, then speed, then cost:** four models measured on the same sentences before any screen was built; the most accurate one, Opus, was too slow for live notes.
- **Specs before code:** product, design and tech specs and a phased plan, kept current; a phone check and a code review closed every phase.

Business model

Affiliate commission from high-end retailers, after v1: each piece links to a retailer such as FWRD, earning an assumed 5% of what shoppers keep. My hypothesis is that a video stylist's personal styling suits higher-ticket items. v1 has no links: sample products only.

Does a session pay? Ten minutes cost $0.95 to $1.65 by voice and $3.95 to $4.65 by video. FWRD's average order was about $640 in 2025, before returns (Revolve Group annual report): $32 at 5%. So about one in 7 or 8 video sessions, or one in 19 to 34 voice sessions, must end in a kept order. Returns earn nothing, so that rate is the riskiest assumption and the first thing to measure.

My role

I'm a product manager, not a developer. I wrote the specs from a PRD, set every target before any result, made every product decision and approved each plan before code changed. Claude Code wrote the code: 73 pull requests from 18 to 31 October, each tested before it merged.

How I measured quality

Targets set on 17 to 21 October 2026, before any result, and never moved.

Measure	Target	Result
Notes within 2 s / right, 63 in-sample sentences	95% / 90%	97% / 96%
Notes within 2 s / right, 15 blind sentences	95% / 90%	85% / 83%, not met
Rule breaks caught, 37 looks	All	16 of 16
Judged looks right	90%	21 of 21
Photo details right, 24 photos	85%	93%
Interruption by button	0.5 s	0.7 s, not met
AI cost per demo	$1.10	$1.15, not met
Phone speed (Lighthouse)	90	98

What I learned

- Measuring before building changed the model choice; a blind set then showed how much my own cases flattered the reader.
- Cost became a product problem: one session's judgments hit the daily allowance in my own check; the limit, plain limit messages and a free Undo followed.
- The automatic accessibility scanner passed, but measuring by hand found five layout problems at 200% text and 44 px, and one conflict in my own spec.

> **Limits:** most answers were mine, so the scores are in-sample; the blind set (15 new sentences, written apart from the reader) scored 83% right and 85% in time: the honest estimate for new sentences. One tester, one iPhone; no stranger yet. Catalog photos, not phone photos. Taste isn't measured, only rules. No purchases yet.

What's next

- A stranger's first session, timed against a 3-minute first look.
- Fix the blind set's misses; add captions or typing.
- A retailer-link pilot: looks saved, kept orders, returns.

In the repository: README, docs/evaluation.md, Project Memory (specs and plan), the architecture diagram, checks. Live at ai-personal-stylist-inky.vercel.app.

Sabine Joseph, AI product manager, directing Claude Code as a non-developer. Code and documents: github.com/sabinejoseph8/ai-personal-stylist.